Theme 1: Retail Therapy

What's in a Name? (Past simple & past simple passive)

Lesson 1-2
Book pages 4-5

💡 **Big idea:** **Branding** is not new; people burned marks on things to show ownership. Companies choose names and **logos** carefully: the Chevrolet **Nova** sold badly in Latin America because 'no va' means 'it doesn't go'. Oman Air's logo is a swirl of **frankincense** smoke. Grammar: **past simple** and **past simple passive**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read about the history of brand names
- Use the past simple for completed past actions
- Use the past simple passive when the action is more important than the doer
- Change active sentences into the passive

📖 Key words

brand علامة تجارية	**logo** شعار	**trademark** علامة مسجلة	**consumer** مستهلك
identity هوية	**heritage** تراث	**founder** مؤسس	**passive** المبني للمجهول

The text: A Short History of Branding

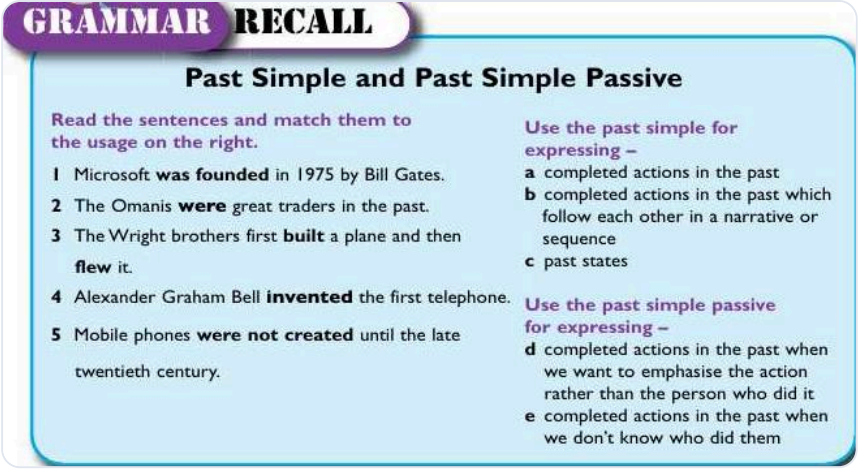
- Branding was used in ancient times to show ownership
- Adidas was taken from the name of its founder, Adolf (Adi) Dassler
- Coca-Cola was named after coca leaves and kola nuts
- Chevrolet Nova did not sell well in Spanish-speaking countries
- Oman Air's new logo (2008) shows a swirl of frankincense smoke

Past simple

- completed actions in the past: The Omanis **were** great traders.
- actions that follow each other in a story: They **built** a plane and then **flew** it.

Past simple passive

- was/were + past participle
- Use it to emphasise the action: Microsoft **was founded** in 1975.
- Use it when we don't know who did it: Mobile phones **were not created** until the late 20th century.



GRAMMAR RECALL

Past Simple and Past Simple Passive

Read the sentences and match them to the usage on the right.

1 Microsoft **was founded** in 1975 by Bill Gates.
2 The Omanis **were** great traders in the past.
3 The Wright brothers first **built** a plane and then **flew** it.
4 Alexander Graham Bell **invented** the first telephone.
5 Mobile phones **were not created** until the late twentieth century.

Use the past simple for expressing –
a completed actions in the past
b completed actions in the past which follow each other in a narrative or sequence
c past states

Use the past simple passive for expressing –
d completed actions in the past when we want to emphasise the action rather than the person who did it
e completed actions in the past when we don't know who did them

Grammar Recall: past simple and past simple passive (p.5)

✏️ Examples

Change to passive: Adolf Dassler founded Adidas.

Answer: Adidas was founded by Adolf Dassler.

Change to passive: Oman Air chose a new logo.

Answer: A new logo was chosen by Oman Air.

⭐ Remember

- Passive = was/were + past participle (made, built, chosen, founded).

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ The logo was choose in 2008. ✓ The logo was chosen in 2008.
- ✗ Adidas founded in 1949. ✓ Adidas was founded in 1949.

🧩 **Activity:** Write five sentences about famous inventions using the past simple passive.

✅ Check yourself

1. Where does the name Adidas come from?
2. What does Oman Air's logo show?
3. Form of the past passive?
4. Why didn't the Nova sell well?

Answers: (1) its founder Adolf (Adi) Dassler ، (2) a swirl of frankincense smoke ، (3) was/were + past participle ، (4) 'no va' means 'it doesn't go' in Spanish